

The Complete Financial Guide for Young Couples

categories. Why? Because when you add them all up, they must total 100 percent. If you have to spend 30 percent for your cars, it is virtually impossible to trim the difference out of the other categories.

I have heard couples complain that 15 percent for automobiles is inadequate. I'm not trying to control your spending, only to provide a guideline. If you can spend 30 percent on automobiles and still balance your income and outgo, that's fine. But unless you have free housing, I don't believe you can.

QUESTION 9. What if my fiancé doesn't want to give?

I like to give money to Christian causes and charities, but my fiancé does not. Could this cause a problem?

ANSWER: Not only can it cause a problem, it can cause a rift in your marriage. The first question you should ask is, "Are we compatible?" Scripture says, "Do not be bound together with unbelievers" (2 Corinthians 6:14). But I also believe the context goes beyond just Christian or non-Christian. It is best not to be bound together if you know you're not compatible in other respects.

You may be at different spiritual levels. It certainly is better to find that out before getting married. I would suggest that you delay getting married for a while, at least until you settle this issue of differing spiritual values.

QUESTION 10. Should we buy a house as soon as we can?

We want to get a house soon after we are married, but would it be wise to wait for a while before buying, even if we can afford it?

ANSWER: Unless you've come into marriage with a big bank-roll, you need to wait. Don't be deceived into thinking that because you can afford the down payment, you can go out and buy a house. Even if you have \$10,000 to \$15,000 to put down on a \$100,000 home, you will still have payments of nearly \$900 a month if the interest rate is 10 percent. Before you